

PartnerAPI

Change Log and Change Control Record

Software Engineering Project

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1 Introduction

This document records the formal change-control process for the two custom feature requests submitted by partner agencies during the PartnerAPI project.

The project baseline is designed to enable the first five partner agencies to go live within the promised ten-week target. The standard scope is therefore protected from one-off requirements that are not required by the wider partner group.

Both custom requests are evaluated using the same six-step change control process:

1. Capture the change request.
2. Understand the reason for the request.
3. Analyse the impact on the project.
4. Decide whether to accept, reject, or defer the request.
5. Update the project plan if the request is accepted.
6. Implement and verify the approved change.

2 Project Baseline

The baseline project estimate is based on the three-point PERT estimates defined in the Estimation Sheet.

The sequential task-level Expected Time (TE) values are:

Activity	TE (days)
API Design	6.33
Booking Endpoints	15.00
Sandbox	6.67
Documentation	5.17
Partner Onboarding	8.67
Baseline Total	41.84

Table 1: PartnerAPI Baseline Estimate

The baseline duration is:

$$\text{Baseline Weeks} = \frac{41.84}{5} = 8.37 \text{ weeks}$$

The target for the first five partners is ten weeks.

Therefore, the baseline schedule has an estimated margin of:

$$10 - 8.37 = 1.63 \text{ weeks}$$

The custom requests must therefore be evaluated carefully because accepting them directly into the baseline could cause the ten-week target to be missed.

3 Change Request Summary

Two partner agencies have requested custom features that are not required by the other partners.

Request	Description	Effort
CR-01	Custom feature requested by Partner 1	12 days
CR-02	Custom feature requested by Partner 2	18 days
Total	Combined custom effort	30 days

Table 2: Custom Partner Change Requests

The requests are partner-specific and are not part of the standard API requirements for the wider partner population.

4 Change Request CR-01

4.1 Step 1 – Capture

Partner 1 submitted a request for a custom feature that is not required by the other partner agencies.

The estimated engineering effort for CR-01 is:

12 days

The request is recorded as CR-01 and is evaluated separately from the standard PartnerAPI baseline.

4.2 Step 2 – Understand the Reason

The purpose of the request is to support a requirement specific to the requesting partner.

The feature does not represent a common requirement across the initial partner group. Therefore, implementing it as part of the standard API would introduce partner-specific behaviour into the baseline scope.

4.3 Step 3 – Analyse Impact

The estimated effort is 12 working days.

If CR-01 were added directly to the baseline:

$$41.84 + 12 = 53.84 \text{ days}$$

The corresponding duration would be:

$$\frac{53.84}{5} = 10.77 \text{ weeks}$$

This would exceed the ten-week target by:

$$10.77 - 10 = 0.77 \text{ weeks}$$

The request would therefore create schedule pressure and reduce the available capacity for testing, integration, documentation, and partner onboarding.

The request would also increase engineering cost. Using the project's planning assumption of 8 working hours per day and a blended engineering rate of 2,000 per hour:

$$12 \times 8 \times 2000 = 1,92,000$$

4.4 Step 4 – Decision

CR-01 is **deferred from the standard ten-week release**.

The standard API should remain focused on functionality required by multiple partner agencies. CR-01 may be considered for a later phase through formal change approval.

4.5 Step 5 – Update the Plan

The baseline project plan remains unchanged.

CR-01 is recorded as a deferred change with:

- Estimated effort: 12 working days.
- Estimated engineering cost: 1,92,000.

- Release decision: Deferred.
- Baseline schedule impact: None.

If the request is approved in a later phase, the project schedule and resource plan must be updated before implementation begins.

4.6 Step 6 – Implement and Verify

CR-01 is not implemented in the standard release.

If subsequently approved, implementation must follow the normal development, testing, documentation, and acceptance process.

Verification must confirm that the custom functionality works as specified without breaking the standard API contract.

5 Change Request CR-02

5.1 Step 1 – Capture

Partner 2 submitted a second custom feature request that is not required by the other partner agencies.

The estimated engineering effort for CR-02 is:

18 days

The request is recorded as CR-02 and is evaluated independently from the standard PartnerAPI baseline.

5.2 Step 2 – Understand the Reason

The request is intended to address a requirement specific to the requesting partner.

Because the requirement is not shared by the wider partner group, including it in the standard API would increase the complexity of the baseline product and introduce functionality that is not required for the initial common release.

5.3 Step 3 – Analyse Impact

The estimated effort is 18 working days.

If CR-02 were added directly to the baseline:

$$41.84 + 18 = 59.84 \text{ days}$$

The corresponding duration would be:

$$\frac{59.84}{5} = 11.97 \text{ weeks}$$

The estimated delay against the ten-week target would therefore be:

$$11.97 - 10 = 1.97 \text{ weeks}$$

The request would therefore cause the first-five-partner release to miss the target if added without additional schedule capacity.

The estimated engineering cost is:

$$18 \times 8 \times 2000 = 2,88,000$$

5.4 Step 4 – Decision

CR-02 is **deferred from the standard ten-week release**.

The request may be reconsidered as a separately approved change or future-phase feature.

5.5 Step 5 – Update the Plan

The baseline project plan remains unchanged.

CR-02 is recorded as a deferred change with:

- Estimated effort: 18 working days.
- Estimated engineering cost: 2,88,000.
- Release decision: Deferred.
- Baseline schedule impact: None.

Any future implementation must receive formal approval and must be added to a revised project plan.

5.6 Step 6 – Implement and Verify

CR-02 is not implemented in the standard release.

If approved later, the feature must be implemented and tested independently before being released to the requesting partner.

Verification must confirm both the requested functionality and continued compatibility with the standard PartnerAPI contract.

6 Combined Change Impact

If both custom requests were accepted into the original baseline, their combined additional effort would be:

$$12 + 18 = 30 \text{ days}$$

The resulting project duration would be:

$$41.84 + 30 = 71.84 \text{ days}$$

Converting the result into working weeks:

$$\frac{71.84}{5} = 14.37 \text{ weeks}$$

The resulting delay against the ten-week target would be:

$$14.37 - 10 = 4.37 \text{ weeks}$$

Therefore, accepting both requests in the baseline would result in an estimated:

4.37-week delay

7 Cost Impact

The project uses the following planning assumptions:

- 8 working hours per day.
- 2,000 per engineering hour.
- The rate is a blended planning assumption for academic estimation and is not a commercial quotation.

The cost of CR-01 is:

$$12 \times 8 \times 2000 = 1,92,000$$

The cost of CR-02 is:

$$18 \times 8 \times 2000 = 2,88,000$$

The combined engineering cost is:

$$1,92,000 + 2,88,000 = \boxed{4,80,000}$$

The baseline engineering cost is:

$$41.84 \times 8 \times 2000 = \boxed{6,69,440}$$

If both requests were accepted, the resulting total engineering cost would be:

$$6,69,440 + 4,80,000 = \boxed{11,49,440}$$

8 Change Decision Log

Table 3: PartnerAPI Change Decision Log

ID	Effort	Impact	Decision	Status
CR-01	12 days	Would increase baseline to 10.77 weeks	Defer to later phase	Deferred
CR-02	18 days	Would increase baseline to 11.97 weeks	Defer to later phase	Deferred

9 Final Scope Decision

The standard PartnerAPI release will contain functionality that is common and reusable across the partner agencies.

The two partner-specific requests will not be included in the standard ten-week release.

This decision is justified because accepting both requests would increase the estimated project duration from:

8.37 weeks

to:

14.37 weeks

resulting in an estimated:

4.37-week delay

against the ten-week target.

Deferring the requests therefore protects the release schedule, keeps the public API simpler, reduces unnecessary partner-specific coupling, and preserves engineering capacity for testing, documentation, security, and onboarding.

10 Change Control Principles

The following principles will be applied to future PartnerAPI change requests:

- Changes must be formally captured before implementation.
- The business reason for each request must be understood.
- Schedule, cost, scope, quality, security, and maintenance impacts must be analysed.
- Changes must be approved before development begins.
- Approved changes must be reflected in the project plan.
- Implementation must be verified through appropriate testing.
- Partner-specific requirements should not automatically become part of the standard public API.

11 Conclusion

The change-control process demonstrates that both custom partner requests can be evaluated objectively using their estimated effort and their impact on the project's ten-week delivery target.

CR-01 requires 12 working days and CR-02 requires 18 working days. Accepting both requests would add 30 working days to the baseline, increasing the estimated project duration from 41.84 days to 71.84 days, or 14.37 working weeks.

The resulting estimated delay of 4.37 weeks makes inclusion of both requests in the standard release inconsistent with the ten-week target.

The final decision is therefore to protect the standard API scope and defer both custom requests to a separately controlled future phase.